

Indian Independence Act 1947

The **Indian Independence Act 1947** is one of the most important laws in South Asian history.

It was the final law that **ended British rule in India** and **created two new countries — India and Pakistan**.

This Act was passed by the **British Parliament on 18 July 1947** and came into action on **15 August 1947**, the day when both countries celebrated their **first Independence Day**.

🏛️ Background

For almost **200 years**, India was under British control.

People struggled hard for freedom through **movements, protests, and sacrifices**.

After 1940, the demand for a **separate country for Muslims** became stronger under the leadership of **Quaid-e-Azam Muhammad Ali Jinnah**.

At last, the British decided to **divide the subcontinent** and give power to Indian leaders.

To make this division **legal and official**, they passed the **Indian Independence Act 1947**.

📋 Main Provisions of the Act

1. End of British Rule:

From **15 August 1947**, British control over India completely ended.

2. Creation of Two Countries:

The subcontinent was divided into two independent dominions:

- **India IN**
- **Pakistan PK** (which included East Bengal, West Punjab, Sindh, NWFP, and Baluchistan)

3. Governor-General for Each Country:

Each dominion got its own Governor-General who represented the British King:

- For India → **Lord Mountbatten**
- For Pakistan → **Muhammad Ali Jinnah**

4. **Constituent Assembly:**

Both dominions got their own **Constituent Assembly**, which could make laws and write their **own Constitution**.

Until new constitutions were made, these assemblies worked as **temporary parliaments**.

5. **Division of Army and Property:**

The **army, navy, civil services, railways, and money** were divided between India and Pakistan.

6. **Princely States:**

There were **562 small princely states** under British India.

They were free to **join India, join Pakistan, or stay independent**, but most joined one of the two.

7. **End of British Authority:**

The **British King's power** over India and Pakistan ended.

Both became **fully independent** and could manage their own affairs.

☐ **Importance of the Act**

- This Act was the **official birth certificate** of India and Pakistan.
 - It **ended nearly 200 years of British rule** in India.
 - It gave both countries the **right to make their own laws and constitutions**.
 - It made the **dream of freedom** come true — the dream for which millions of people had **struggled and sacrificed**.
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Who Presented the Act?

The Act was presented by **Lord Mountbatten**, the **last Viceroy of India**, under the **British Government of Prime Minister Clement Attlee**.

Interesting Facts

- The Act was passed **very quickly — in just two weeks**, which was one of the fastest in British history.
- Lord Mountbatten wanted to transfer power **before June 1948**, but due to rising tensions, he did it earlier — on **15 August 1947**.

- The date **15 August** was chosen because it was also the **second anniversary of Japan's surrender in World War II**, which the British thought was a lucky day.
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Conclusion

The **Indian Independence Act 1947** was not just a law — it was the **start of a new era** for millions of people.

It gave **freedom, hope, and a new identity** to both India and Pakistan.

Even though the **partition caused pain and loss**, it also gave birth to **two proud nations** that began their journey of independence.